

React Component Styling Hands-On Lab — Solution

Styling the Cognizant Academy Cohort Dashboard with CSS Modules and Inline Styles

Objectives

- Understand the need for styling React components
- Work with CSS Modules and inline styles

In this hands-on lab, you will learn how to:

- Style a React component
- Define styles using a CSS Module
- Apply styles to components using the `className` and style properties

Prerequisites

- Node.js
- NPM
- Visual Studio Code

Task

The Academy team at Cognizant wants a dashboard showing the details of ongoing and completed cohorts. A React application already displays this data using a cohort details component. Your task is to style that component: give each cohort card a bordered "box" look using a CSS Module, style all `<dt>` elements with a tag selector, and make the cohort name (`<h3>`) appear green when the cohort's status is "ongoing" and blue otherwise.

Solution — Step by Step

Step 1: Unzip the React application

Extract the downloaded application archive into a folder of your choice.

Step 2: Open a command prompt in the project folder

Open a command prompt / terminal and switch into the extracted application folder:

```
cd path\to\cohort-dashboard
```

Step 3: Restore the node packages

Install the project's dependencies by running:

```
npm install
```

Step 4: Open the application in VS Code

```
code .
```

Step 5: Create the CSS Module

In the same folder as the cohort details component (typically src/components), create a new file named CohortDetails.module.css.

Step 6: Define the "box" class

Add a box class to CohortDetails.module.css with the required dimensions, spacing, and border:

```
.box {
  width: 300px;
  display: inline-block;
  margin: 10px;
  padding: 10px 20px;
  border: 1px solid black;
  border-radius: 10px;
}
```

Step 7: Style the <dt> element with a tag selector

In the same file, add a tag selector for <dt> and set its font weight to 500:

```
dt {
  font-weight: 500;
}
```

Step 8: Import the CSS Module into the cohort details component

Open CohortDetails.js and import the CSS Module at the top of the file:

```
import styles from './CohortDetails.module.css';
```

Step 9: Apply the box class to the container div

Apply the box class from the imported module to the component's outer container div using className:

```
<div className={styles.box}>
  /* existing cohort detail markup */
</div>
```

Step 10: Color the <h3> based on cohort status

Since the color depends on data that changes at runtime (the cohort's status), apply it with an inline style rather than the CSS Module: green when the status is "ongoing", blue for any other status:

```
<h3
  style={{
    color: cohort.status === 'ongoing' ? 'green' : 'blue'
  }}
>
  {cohort.name}
</h3>
```

Complete CohortDetails.js (illustrative)

Combining all the changes above, the component follows this overall shape (adapt the prop and field names to match your actual project):

```
import React from 'react';
import styles from './CohortDetails.module.css';

function CohortDetails({ cohort }) {
  return (
    <div className={styles.box}>
      <h3
        style={{
          color: cohort.status === 'ongoing' ? 'green' : 'blue'
        }}
      >
        {cohort.name}
      </h3>
      <dl>
        <dt>Status</dt>
        <dd>{cohort.status}</dd>
        <dt>Start Date</dt>
        <dd>{cohort.startDate}</dd>
        <dt>End Date</dt>
        <dd>{cohort.endDate}</dd>
      </dl>
    </div>
  );
}

export default CohortDetails;
```

Step 11: Run the application and verify the result

Start the development server:

```
npm start
```

Open a browser window and type the following in the address bar:

```
http://localhost:3000
```

Each cohort should now render as a bordered, rounded box 300px wide with consistent spacing, bold-ish (weight 500) labels for every <dt>, and a cohort name that shows green for ongoing cohorts and blue for completed (or any other) cohorts — matching the target result shown in the lab.

Result

The cohort details component was styled using a CSS Module (CohortDetails.module.css) that defines a reusable box class for card-style layout and a tag selector for <dt> elements. The box class was applied to the component's container via className, while the cohort name's color — which depends on the cohort's runtime status — was applied using an inline style expression. The result was verified by running the application and confirming the dashboard matches the expected styled output.